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Items of Discussion:

- Update for professor's Concerns on project complexity (personalization, bandit)
- Current application pipeline based on our understanding (yuexi)
- Questions about the SRS document (due on Oct 9)
- Open discussion(times for ask feedback)

Discussion Notes and Outcomes:

slm priority

AI can be used multiple times(shouldn't be limited)

limit the sample to small size (5?)

Tom:

Confirmed rewarding mechanism and bandit selector workflow using hyperparameter a(student helpfulness) + (1-a)(instructor thinks helpfulness) (only inspect a randomize sample of revisions for MAB rewarding mechanism as too many revisions will create a burden for instructor)

Student can click on asking for AI feedback several times and submit for grading only once

Amber will talk to Angela for hiring people for improving bandit selector

Need to deploying application

Dataset in Jan.

Summary：

Project Complexity

- The core complexity lies in the bandit selector and SLM personalization. A system relying solely on API calls without these features would appear static.
- The bandit selector needs continuous learning through student interactions and a reward mechanism.

Application Testing and Evaluation

- Hiring students for performance testing depends on the prototype's stage of development and Research Ethics Board (REB) approval.
- Alternative testing options include creating our own gold evaluation datasets and having team members test the application.
- Collecting student data to improve the bandit selector requires REB approval.
- Formal studies involving students generating responses may take place later. If REB approval is obtained, Angela and the primary researcher would manage this work, potentially during the spring term.

AI Feedback Usage

- Instructors may consider time delays to discourage rapid, repetitive requests.
- Misuse would be handled by instructors rather than through a system-enforced usage limit.

Grading Context

- McMaster's implementation will likely focus on grading the final product.
- The U of T example allowed resubmissions for bonus marks but relied on extensive manual written feedback and specially trained TAs, rather than an automated revision-tracking system.
- The current project aims to use LLMs to support feedback within more limited funding.

Reward Score Details

- Student ratings would reflect the perceived helpfulness of AI feedback, while instructor evaluations would assess actual writing improvement.
- A "liking system" and a student helpfulness rating on a scale of 1–100 were discussed as possible rating methods.
- Rewards could potentially be reduced when feedback is repetitive or unhelpful, such as repeatedly giving the same advice about organization.

Deployment

- The current plan is to deploy the application on department servers. Angela has successfully deployed similar projects.
- Server costs are not an immediate concern.